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Deputy Director of Enterprise Security & Risk Management

Department for Work and Pensions

Apply before 11:55 pm on Monday 31st August 2026



Reference number

475398

Salary

£86,000 - £104,000

Existing Civil Servants will be appointed in line with the Civil Service pay rules in place on the date of their appointment, this will usually be the salary minimum or within 10% of their existing salary for those applying on promotion. Individuals appointed on level transfer will retain their existing base salary.

A Civil Service Pension with an employer contribution of 28.97%

Job grade

SCS Pay Band 1

Contract type

Permanent

Business area

DWP - Finance

Type of role

Risk Management
Security

Working pattern

Flexible working, Full-time, Job share

Number of jobs available

1

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Location

London

About the job

Job summary

Shape how one of the UK's largest organisations understands and responds to security risk.

This is a unique opportunity for an experienced governance, risk and assurance leader to shape how DWP understands, manages and acts on security risk. We are looking for someone who can bring clarity, pace and innovation to enterprise security risk management; who is confident working with complex evidence, assurance and threat information; and who can translate that insight into decisions that influence senior leaders across the whole organisation. The function is already mature and well-respected; you will have the opportunity to build and shape the credibility of the function across the Department, Government and the wider industry.

You will be a natural relationship builder, comfortable operating in a large, complex delivery organisation in either the public or private sector. You will need to inspire confidence with Ministers, the Permanent Secretary, the Departmental Audit, Risk and Assurance Committee, senior colleagues and your own teams through the quality of your judgement, the strength of your evidence, and your ability to help the organisation act on the risks that matter most. This is a role for someone who cares deeply about impact: not simply reporting risk and assurance, but changing behaviour, improving resilience and enabling better outcomes for millions of citizens.

We are looking for an inclusive, credible and ambitious senior leader to support me in leading the teams that provide proportionate, well-informed security and risk advice to the Department and its senior leaders. Values and making Security & Data Protection Directorate within DWP a brilliant place to work will be important to you. You will thrive on delivering outcomes and making wider contributions to Government Security and the Civil Service.

To learn more about this opportunity, hear directly from Mike Fell, Chief Security Officer and vacancy holder.

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For more information about DWP and this role, please see the Candidate Pack attached.

Hear more about DWP

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Job description

As Deputy Director of Enterprise Security & Risk Management, the accountabilities of the postholder include:

Enterprise Risk Management - Lead the organisation's security risk function, ensuring enterprise-level security risks are identified, assessed, prioritised and effectively managed in alignment with the organisation's risk appetite or agreed risk tolerance.

Security Oversight - Develop and deliver the department's enterprise security governance model and associated boards, ensuring alignment with corporate strategy, governance, regulatory requirements and risk appetite.

Governance, Risk & Compliance - Lead Governance Risk & Compliance (GRC) activities, ensuring it is aligned, proportionate, transparent, compliant and business-centric. Provide programme and service-specific risk advice aligned to policy and risk appetite. Work closely with Security Policy & Awareness teams to deliver joined up security.

Third-Party Security Assurance - Responsible for the organisation's multi-tiered supplier assurance programme, ensuring all third-party security risks are assessed, monitored and actively managed throughout the contract lifecycle in a proportionate, risk-based manner.

IT Security Assurance - Deliver a holistic, balanced programme of independent assurance over IT security architecture and associated controls providing confidence in technology-driven risk including mandatory external and internal assurance and compliance activity.

Physical Security Assurance - Responsible for evaluating, testing and verifying the organisation's physical security measures across circa 850 locations ensuring site- and enterprise-level resilience measures are robust, risk-aligned and compliant with external requirements.

Regulatory & Audit Engagement - Acts as the primary interface with internal audit, external auditors, and wider government bodies, ensuring clear evidence of security risk management and control effectiveness.

Leadership of a Dispersed Workforce - Lead a team of 90 security, risk and assurance professionals across multiple UK locations, building a unified culture, clear accountability and high performing team.

Strategic Advisor - Advises the Chief Security Officer, Executive Team and other boards on systemic risks and strategic investment priorities to manage those risks.

Management - Accountable for the efficient running of the team, including a multi-million-pound budget, accurate forecasting, and HR, finance and commercial compliance.

Person specification

The successful candidate must be able to demonstrate their knowledge, experience and skills against the following essential criteria:

Proven senior security leadership experience, with a track record of leading and inspiring large, geographically dispersed teams through an engaging, authentic and adaptable leadership style. The successful candidate will demonstrate exceptional interpersonal and influencing skills, with the credibility to build trusted relationships at all levels of the organisation. They will possess high levels of emotional intelligence, sound judgement, executive presence, diplomacy and adaptability.

Security Governance, Risk & Compliance (GRC) expertise - recognised expertise in security GRC, with experience establishing and leading enterprise-wide, cross-domain security governance, risk management and compliance frameworks within complex organisations. This will include deep knowledge of relevant regulations, frameworks and standards, together with experience of managing risk across both legacy and modern technology environments. This expertise should be evidenced through relevant professional qualifications and memberships (e.g. CISM, CISA, CISSP, CRISC, GRC(A), Chartered Security/Cyber Profession status).

Excellent communication and stakeholder management skills, with the ability to influence senior leaders and communicate complex security and risk issues clearly to both technical and non-technical audiences.

Experience leading security assurance across complex supply chains and outsourced service models, ensuring effective governance, risk management and resilience across third-party environments.

Behaviours

We'll assess you against these behaviours during the selection process:

Leadership

Seeing the Big Picture

Changing and Improving

Delivering at Pace

Benefits

Alongside your salary of £86,000, Department for Work and Pensions contributes £24,914 towards you being a member of the Civil Service Defined Benefit Pension scheme. [Find out what benefits a Civil Service Pension provides \(opens in a new window\)](#).

DWP have a broad benefits package built around your work-life balance which includes:

Working patterns to support work/life balance such as job sharing, term-time working, flexi-time and compressed hours.

Generous annual leave at least 25 days on entry, increasing up to 30 days over time (pro rata for part time employees), plus 9 days public and privilege leave.

Support for financial wellbeing, including interest-free season ticket loans for travel, a cycle to work scheme and an employee discount scheme.

Health and wellbeing support including our Employee Assistance Programme for specialist advice and counselling and the opportunity to join HASSRA a first-class programme of competitions, activities and benefits for its members (subscription payable monthly).

Family friendly policies including enhanced maternity and shared parental leave pay after 1 year's continuous service.

Funded learning and development to support progress in your role and career. This includes industry recognised qualifications and accreditations, coaching, mentoring and talent development programmes.

An inclusive and diverse environment with opportunities to join professional and interpersonal networks including Women's Network, National Race Network, National Disability Network (THRIVE) and many more.

Reasonable Adjustments

At DWP we value diversity and inclusion and actively encourage and welcome applications from everyone, especially those that are underrepresented in our workforce. We consider visible and non-visible disabilities, neurodiversity or learning differences, chronic medical conditions, or mental ill health. Examples include dyslexia, epilepsy, autism, chronic fatigue, or schizophrenia.

If you need a change to be made so that you can make your application, please contact senior.recruitment@dwp.gov.uk as soon as possible, before the closing date to discuss your needs. Complete the Reasonable Adjustments section in the Additional requirements page of your application form to tell us what changes or help you might need further on in the recruitment process.

Disability Confident Scheme

The Civil Service embraces diversity and promotes equal opportunities. DWP is recognised as a Disability Confident Leader, demonstrating the departmental commitment to attracting, recruiting and retaining disabled people and supporting them in achieving their full potential. We run the Disability Confident Scheme (DCS) for candidates with disabilities who meet

the minimum selection criteria for the advertised role. To be considered for an interview, you must have:

a physical or mental impairment which has a substantial and long term (over 12 months) adverse effect on your ability to carry out normal day to day activities; or a long-term health condition; and demonstrated that you meet all the minimum qualifying criteria set out in the advertisement for the post at the application and testing stages.

A full definition and examples of conditions can be found on this webpage. You will be asked at the initial application stage if you wish to apply via the scheme

Things you need to know

Artificial intelligence

Artificial intelligence can be a useful tool to support your application, however, all examples and statements provided must be truthful, factually accurate and taken directly from your own experience. Where plagiarism has been identified (presenting the ideas and experiences of others, or generated by artificial intelligence, as your own) applications may be withdrawn and internal candidates may be subject to disciplinary action. Please see our [candidate guidance \(opens in a new window\)](#) for more information on appropriate and inappropriate use.

Selection process details

This vacancy is using [Success Profiles \(opens in a new window\)](#), and will assess your Behaviours.

Application Process

To apply for this post, you will need to complete the online application **via Saxton Bampfylde** process outlined below no later than **Monday the 31st of August at 23:55:**

A **CV** setting out your career history, with key responsibilities and achievements. Please ensure you have provided reasons for any gaps within the last two years;

A **personal statement** (maximum 1250 words), explaining how you consider your personal skills, qualities, and experience provide evidence of your suitability for the role, with particular reference to the essential criteria in the person specification.

Failure to submit both documents will mean the panel has only limited information on which to assess your application against the criteria in the person specification.

Longlist

Depending on the volume of applications received, a longlisting process may be undertaken. As part of this process, candidates will be interviewed by Corrie Cowlard or Jonathan Morgan, Consultants at Saxton Bampfylde, the executive search firm appointed to manage this recruitment on behalf of DWP. These discussions are intended to explore candidates' experience and motivation in greater depth and do not form a pass/fail assessment. Instead, they provide additional evidence to support the panel's overall evaluation when determining which candidates best meet the requirements of the role and should be invited to the next stage of the process.

Shortlist

A panel, including the hiring manager, will assess applications against the person specification and shortlist those demonstrating the strongest evidence of suitability for the role. Failure to address any or all of these may affect your application.

The timeline stated in the Candidate Pack attached indicates the date by which a decision is expected to be made, and all shortlisted candidates will be advised of the outcome as soon as possible thereafter.

Assessment

If you are shortlisted, you will be asked to take part in a **Staff Engagement Exercise on the 30/09/2026, via MS Teams**, in advance of the interview. This assessment will not result in a pass or fail decision. Rather, it is designed to support the panel's decision making and highlight areas for the panel to explore further at interview.

Shortlisted candidates may have the opportunity to speak to Mike Fell, prior to the final interview. This is an informal discussion to allow candidates to learn more about the role and is not part of the assessment process.

Interview

Shortlisted candidates will be invited to attend a panel interview to discuss your previous experience and professional competence in relation to the criteria set out in the person specification. You will be asked to prepare a 5-minute presentation. Full details will be provided prior to the interview.

Your interview will take place face to face on **Tuesday 13 October 2026 at Caxton House, London**. Further details will be confirmed nearer the time. The interview panel will be chaired by Mike Fell, who will be supported by additional panel members. The final panel interview will be a blended interview, covering Behaviours, Technical skills and Experience. A blended interview aims to be more of a conversation exploring the candidate's capability for the role.

Offer and Feedback

Regardless of the outcome, we will notify all candidates as soon as possible. We will offer the opportunity to discuss feedback for all candidates who reached interview.

A reserve list will be held for up to 12 months, which we may use to fill future similar vacancies for candidates who are considered appointable following interview.

Feedback will only be provided if you attend an interview or assessment.

This role has a minimum assignment duration of 3 years. An assignment duration is the period of time a Senior Civil Servant is expected to remain in the same post to enable them to deliver on the agreed key business outcomes. The assignment duration also supports your career through building your depth of expertise.

As part of accepting this role you will be agreeing to the expected assignment duration set out above. This will not result in a contractual change to your terms and conditions. Please note this is an expectation only, it is not something which is written into your terms and conditions or indeed which the employing organisation or you are bound by. It will depend on your personal circumstances at a particular time and business needs, for example, would not preclude any absence like family friendly leave. It is nonetheless an important expectation, which is why we ask you to confirm you agree to the assignment duration set out above.

Security

Successful candidates must undergo a basic (or equivalent) criminal record check.

Successful candidates must meet the security requirements before they can be appointed. The level of security needed is [developed vetting \(opens in a new window\)](#).

[See our vetting charter \(opens in a new window\)](#).

People working with government assets must complete [baseline personnel security standard \(opens in new window\)](#) checks.

Nationality requirements

This job is broadly open to the following groups:

- UK nationals

- nationals of the Republic of Ireland

nationals of Commonwealth countries who have the right to work in the UK
nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and
family members of those nationalities with settled or pre-settled status
under the [European Union Settlement Scheme \(EUSS\)](#) (opens in a new
window)

nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and
family members of those nationalities who have made a valid application
for settled or pre-settled status under the European Union Settlement
Scheme (EUSS)

individuals with limited leave to remain or indefinite leave to remain who
were eligible to apply for EUSS on or before 31 December 2020

Turkish nationals, and certain family members of Turkish nationals, who
have accrued the right to work in the Civil Service

[Further information on nationality requirements](#) (opens in a new window)

Working for the Civil Service

The [Civil Service Code](#) (opens in a new window) sets out the standards of
behaviour expected of civil servants.

We recruit by merit on the basis of fair and open competition, as outlined in
the Civil Service Commission's [recruitment principles](#) (opens in a new
window).

The Civil Service embraces diversity and promotes equal opportunities. As
such, we run a Disability Confident Scheme (DCS) for candidates with
disabilities who meet the minimum selection criteria.

The Civil Service also offers a Redeployment Interview Scheme to civil
servants who are at risk of redundancy, and who meet the minimum
requirements for the advertised vacancy.

Diversity and Inclusion

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever
it is found. To learn more please see the [Civil Service People Plan](#) (opens in a
new window) and the [Civil Service Diversity and Inclusion Strategy](#) (opens in
a new window).

Apply and further information

This vacancy is part of the [Great Place to Work for Veterans \(opens in a new window\)](#) initiative.

Once this job has closed, the job advert will no longer be available. You may want to save a copy for your records.

Contact point for applicants

Job contact :

Name : Belinda Beck

Email : belinda.beck@saxbam.com

Recruitment team

Email : senior.recruitment@dwp.gov.uk

Further information

What do I do if I want to make a complaint?

The law requires that selection for appointment to the Civil Service is on merit on the basis of fair and open competition as outlined in the Civil Service Commission's Recruitment Principles.

If you feel your application has not been treated in accordance with the Recruitment Principles and you wish to make a complaint, you should in the first instance contact: senior.recruitment@dwp.gov.uk

If you are not satisfied with the response you receive you can contact the Civil Service Commission.

senior.recruitment@dwp.gov.uk



